



The beginning after the end [turtle me]

FULL

Author: [Theexxiled](#)

© WebNovel



Chapter 1: The Light at the End of the Tunnel ²

I never believed in the whole "light at the end of the tunnel" bullshit where people, after experiencing near-death experiences, wake up in cold sweat exclaiming, "I saw the light!" ¹

But here I am currently at this so-called "tunnel" facing towards this bright light when the last thing I remember, I was sleeping in my room (while others call the royal chamber). ²

Did someone assassinate me?

I don't remember wronging anyone. But then again, being a public figure of power can give others all sorts of reasons to want me dead.

Anyways....

Since it doesn't seem like I'm going to wake up anytime soon and I'm slowly gravitating towards this bright light, I might as well go along with it.



Instead, my vision of everything around turned into a blur of a bright red white. Sounds assaulted my ears. When I try to say anything, the only sound that comes out seems to be a cry.

I hear muffled voices becoming clearer and I make out a, "Congratulations Madam, congratulations Sir, he's a healthy boy." 6

...Wait

I guess normally, I should be thinking along the lines of "Sh*t, was I just born. Am I a baby now?"

But strangely, the only thought that seemed to pop up in my mind was "So the bright light at the end of the tunnel is the light coming through into the female vag..." 6

Haha... lets not think about it anymore.

Assessing my situation like the kingly king I am, I noticed, first of all, that wherever I was born into, I understand the language. That's good.

Next, after slowly and painfully opening my eyes, my retinas were bombarded with different colors and figures. It took a bit of time for my infant eyes to even start working. The doctor, or so it seems, in front of me had a not so appealing face with long greying hair on both head and chin. I swear his glasses were thick enough to be bulletproof. The strange thing was, he wasn't wearing a doctor's gown nor were we even in a hospital room. I seemed to have been born in some satanic summoning ritual room because this room was lit only by a couple of candles and we were on the floor.

I look around and see the female who pushed me out of her tunnel. Calling her mother should be fair. Taking a few more seconds to see what she looks like, I have to admit she's a beauty, but that might be my half blurry eyes. Rather than a glamorous beauty, I would better describe her as lovely, in a very kind and gentle sense with distinct auburn hair and brown eyes. I can't help but notice her long eyelashes and perky nose that makes me want to just cling to her. She just permeates this mother-like feel. Is this how babies are attracted to their mothers?



"Hi little Art, I'm your daddy, can you say dada?" I glance around to see both my mother and the house doctor (for all the certification he seems to have), roll their eyes and my mother manages to scoff, "Honey, he was just born."

I take a closer look at my father and I can see why my lovely mother was attracted to him. Besides the few loose screws he seemed to have by expecting a newborn to articulate a two-syllable word (Where I'm just going to give him the benefit of the doubt and think he said that out of the joy of becoming a father), He was a very charismatic-looking man. With a square jaw line cleanly shaven. His hair, having a very ashy brown color, seemed to be kept short, while his eyebrows were strong and fierce, extending in a sword-like fashion meeting to a V shape. Yet his eyes had a gentle quality, whether it was from the way his eyes drooped a little at the end or from the deep blue, almost sapphire, color his irises radiated. ²

By the time I finished checking out... I mean observing my parents; the wannabe doctor excused himself saying, "Please continue resting for a couple of days Mr. Leywin, and let me know if anything happens to Arthur, Mr. Leywin."

The following couple of weeks after my journey out of the tunnel were a new kind of torture for me. I had little to no motor control over my limbs except waving them around and even that got tiring quickly. I realized that babies don't really get to control their fingers all that much. I don't know how to break it to you, but when you place your fingers on a baby's palm, they don't grab it because they like you, they grab it because, like getting hit in the funny bone, it's a reflex. Forget motor control, I can't even excrete my wastes at my discretion. It just... comes out. Haa... ⁴

A positive was that I was breastfed by my mother. ¹

Don't get me wrong, no ulterior motives whatsoever. It's just that breast milk tastes a lot better than baby formula okay and has more nutritional value okay. Er... please believe me. ⁹

The Satanic demon-summoning place seems to be my parent's room and from what I figure, this place that I'm stuck in is, hopefully, a place in my world that is from the past, where electricity isn't yet invented.

My mother quickly proved my hopes wrong when she one day healed a scratch on my leg when my idiotic father bumped me against a drawer.

No...Not like, band-aid and a kiss heal, but a full blown, shining light with a faint hum from her fucking hands heal. ³



my mother, named Alice Leywin, and my father, named Reynolds Leywin, at seem to be good people, hell if not the best. I suspect my mother is an angel because I've never met such a kindhearted, warm person. While being carried her back by a baby cradle-strap of some sort, I went with her to what she called town. This town of Ashber is more of a glorified outpost, seeing that there are no roads, no buildings. We walked on the main dirt trail where there were tents on both sides with various merchants and salesman/woman selling all sorts of things, from common, everyday needs to things I thought couldn't help but widen my eyes at, like weapons and armor and rocks... shining rocks! 3

The strangest thing that I can't seem to get used to are the people carrying weapons like it was part of their apparel. I witnessed a man of around 170cm carrying a gigantic war axe larger than him! Anyway, mother keeps talking to me probably to try to get me to learn the language faster, while shopping for the groceries, exchanging pleasantries with various people passing by or working the booths. Meanwhile, my body is turning against me once again, and I fell asleep... Damn this useless body.

Sitting on the lap of my mother who was caressing me in her bosom, I was intently focused on my dad currently casting a chant for a good minute, which sounded like a prayer to the earth. I leaned in closer and closer, almost falling from my human seat while expecting some magical phenomenon, like an earthquake spitting the ground or a giant stone golem emerging. After what seemed like eternity (trust me, for an infant who has the attention span of a goldfish, it was long). Three adult, human-sized boulders came out of the ground and slammed against a nearby tree. 2

What in the name of...that was it?

I flailed my arms up in anger and regret but my idiot father interpreted that as "WOW" and had a big grin on his face saying, "Your daddy is awesome huh!"

No, my father was a much better warrior. When he put on his two iron gauntlets, even I felt compelled to drop my underwear (or diaper) for him. With agile movements that were surprising for his build, his fists carried the force to break through the sound barrier, but were fluid enough to not leave an opening. In my world, he could be classed as an elite, leading a platoon of a hundred soldiers, but to me, he was my idiot father. 1



that sense, it wasn't too different from my world except the lack of technology and the slight difference between magic and Ki here. ¹

In my old world, Wars became an almost obsolete form of settling disputes between countries. Don't get me wrong, of course there were still battles on a smaller scale and armies were still needed for the safety of the citizens. However, disputes concerning the wellbeing of a country were based on either a duel between the rulers of the their country, limited to making use of Ki and close combat weapons, or a mock battle between platoons, where limited firearms were allowed, for the smaller disputes. ²

Therefore, Kings weren't the typical fat man sitting on throne ignorantly commanding others, but had to be the strongest, smartest man to represent himself or her country. ³

Enough about that though.

The currency in this new world seemed pretty straightforward from the exchanges my mother had with the merchants.

Copper being the lowest form of currency, then Silver, then Gold. While I have to see anything costing as much as a Gold coin, normal families seem to be able to live fine off of a couple copper coins a day.

18

100 Copper = 1 Silver

100 Silver = 1 Gold

Everyday involved honing my new body, mastering the motor functions residing deep within me.

Then one day everything changed... ³

End of chapter



COMMENT

18 comment



Vote

1 left



Chapter 2: The Encyclopedia of Mana Manipulation



countries as well as my own to settle disputes and maintain my position. In terms of swordsmanship and controlling Ki, I was second to none, for having personal strength was essential to becoming a ruler in my past world on Earth. Kings weren't born but were raised. Yet, I can't think of a prouder moment than now

I can crawl baby! 1

'Till now, I had to make do with the stories mother would tell me while trying to make me fall asleep. I grumbled out noises of complaints when she stopped talking soon. My father would sometimes sit me on his lap while idly talking to me about his old days, which gave me some hints as to what kind of world this was and what it was filled with. 1

Reynolds Leywin, former adventurer, (apparently that's an occupation in this world) had quite a lot of experience in this field. He was in several parties that went on expeditions to search for treasure and fulfill missions they acquired from the Adventurer Guild. He eventually settled down when he met my mother on the borders of the Kingdom in a city called Valden. He proudly told me how my mother was head over heels for him at first sight when he visited the town's Adventurer Guild hall she worked at, but I suspect it was the opposite from how my mother slapped him across the back of the head and told him to stop telling Art lies. 2

My name is Arthur Leywin now, by the way. Art for short, which, as a former King, sounds a little too cute, but hey, after getting a glimpse of myself in the metal sheet they use as a mirror in the washroom, I looked freaking adorable with my mother's glowing auburn hair while my eyes are a bright azure color, inherited from my father. I don't know how my facial features are going to turn out as I mature but as long as I don't turn out fat, it'll be okay.

Watch out future ladies! Prepare to be heartbroken! 6

Weeks of attempting to crawl, yet only succeeding in barely scuffling in place, succeeded in crawling, managing to sneak into the family's library/study room while my mother was hanging the laundry out to dry. Mother rued the day I started to become mobile, sighing, "I swear, you're going to become as hard to manage as your father."



upright is damn tiring. 1

Pondering what I just read, this world seemed pretty underdeveloped. From what I can infer, there doesn't seem to be much technology. The only source of transportation seems to be horse driven carriages, varying in size for land, and ships with sails for rivers.

Weapons were freely allowed and not really regulated unless you were visiting the royal family or people of that much authority. For God's sake, it continues to baffle me every time I see people carrying weapons while shopping for groceries.

Sure, in my previous world, Earth, there were soldiers and guards who carried concealed weapons, but they weren't for the purpose of killing but to deter crime from happening.

But here, I witnessed a thief who stole a couple of items from the armory store the other day get chopped in half across the waist by a large, bald mercenary carrying a polearm. Seeing that, the citizens even went as far as to applaud that over-sized monk!

A similarity that both this world and my previous world shared is the system of monarchy. This continent of Dicathen has Kingdoms where each Kingdom consists of a King and royal family that rules. Unlike Earth though, the King is chosen based on lineage, going from the son of the King, to his son and so on. 18

After scanning through the encyclopedia, there doesn't seem to be much information on other continents besides the one we're currently in. That's strange, there are ships that carry goods and passengers across the continent through rivers, but maybe the technology on ships haven't been developed enough to sail across oceans. 4

One thing that was going to be hard getting used to is the whole premise of ninjutsu in this world. If we're talking about superhuman powers, sure, the countries on Earth relied on people with them.

On Earth, practitioners learned how to condense and utilize the innate ki that they had in their body. Think of it as a muscle if you will. Breaking the ki center down through overuse and resting it caused the ki center to become stronger, allowing for a bigger pool of ki to access from. Then the ki is channeled through the body at will and utilized for strengthening of the body.



Mages, would use the surrounding mana and draw it into their body and condense it in their mana core. In my old world, Earth, ki only existed and was formed inside the body. Whether ki never existed on Earth in the first place or ceased to exist because of the pollution caused by humans, we didn't know.

On Earth, while practice was incredibly important, your innate ki center size is extremely important because of the limited amount of ki you have in your body. All that you can work with, does that mean one's innate mana core size doesn't matter as much because of the available mana in the atmosphere?

The bigger the cup, the more you can hold right?

While in my old world, even though my ki center wasn't that large, I was considered a prodigy at channeling and utilizing my ki effectively to make up for my not so big ki center. With the way I utilized every bit of my ki, I was able to become the strongest of the elite division of Duelists, earning the right to become King.

Now, if I can still practice the ways ki practitioners use their ki, but do it with mana that is both innate inside the mana core and in the surrounding atmosphere, can't I essentially double? No triple the strength that I had before.

The book that I next managed to pull from the bottom shelf, explained a couple of questions for me.

18

"Beginner's Guide for the Privileged Mages"

"While the power to control mana is largely genetic, there are many cases where children of Magi come out as unable to sense the mana around them. A recent census shows that roughly 1 in 100 children are able to sense mana but can be tested to show the extent when the mana core first completely develops, which can be anywhere from early adolescence to late teen years. It is apparent when Magi first awaken by the initial repulsion of the surrounding mana around them when the mana core first forms. This results in a translucent barrier formed around the awakened that lasts a couple of minutes."

Flipping through the pages, I find something that catches my attention.

"...Mana can be used in a couple of ways. The two most common methods of utilizing mana comes through enhancing of the body through mana use (Augmenter), and emission of mana to the outside world (Conjurer)..." 1



"... The practice of Conjuring is seen in Mages, who, after utilizing their mana cast spells to give it a certain effect on the surrounding area or directly on the target."

Weaknesses and Limitation

"While Augmenters can possess incredible strength, defense and agility, their weakness lies in their limited range..."

"Conjurers possess unfathomable powers, being able to bend their surroundings at will. However, such powers come with limits. Unlike Enhancers who utilize most of the mana used from their own mana core, Conjurers need to borrow mana from the outside world in addition to their own mana core to exert mana into the surrounding in a form of a spell."

"While both types of Mages, or Mana Manipulators for the more scientifically accurate term, depend on and is categorized by their mana core, Augmenters and Conjurers also have different ways of measuring their aptitude."

"flip"

"An Augmenter's prowess or talent is measured by the power of mana channels in their body, which measures the speed and efficiency in exerting their mana from their mana core into various parts of the body..."

18

"...A Conjurer's power and talent, comparatively, is measured by the power of mana veins, which indicates the speed and effectiveness of absorbing mana from the outside world to cast a spell."

"flip"

"...Mages (Mana Manipulators) are typically categorized into one of these two divisions since attempting to be proficient in both is incredibly time consuming and inefficient. Most are born with a skewed difference in their mana channels and mana veins..."

"...Augmenters do not need very strong mana veins because they mostly utilize the mana from their core, while Conjurers do not need very powerful mana channels because they do not spread their mana into their own body."

Hmm... So my idiot father seems to be a competent Augmenter and a less than average Conjurer.

That healing light though... What was my mother?



AHA!

"There are a few, rare deviants. While there are still some undiscovered, ones are highly sought after are the Emitters, more commonly known as healers. Healers possess the rare ability to cast their unique restorative mana unto others directly, recovering injuries and impairments."

Wow... mother is the best.

Fundamentals of Conjuring

"The proper steps for utilizing the mana for Conjurers is to gather the surrounding mana in the area, drawing it into your body, then, after circulating into your mana core to stabilize and purify the atmosphere's diluted mana, you channel it into an appropriate conductor (a staff, wand, ring, of some sort) with the incantations as a mental controller for your will into shaping the mana to whatever spell you want..."

"flip"

"...The more powerful the spell, the longer it takes to draw in from the surrounding mana, store it in your mana core where it condenses and purifies and finally channel and release..."

"flip"

18

"Because Conjuring involves exerting focused mana into a particular spell, Conjurers will notice that they have a special aptitude of certain elements (Air, Water, Fire, Earth). But with proper training, can become adequate in the basics of all elements."

"flip, flip"

Fundamentals of Augmenting

"Unlike Conjuring, much less time can be spent gathering the surrounding mana. Efficient use of Augmenting requires speed and precision in the use of the mana from your core and less from the mana in the atmosphere..."

This is where it clicked.... Augmenting was very close to using your ki except you can also draw mana in from your surroundings. The reason why there weren't any kinds of conjurers in my old world of Earth was because there was no mana in the atmosphere to draw in and create a phenomenon.

My gaze tensed as I read on. 4



Augmenting requires much insight into the individual's own body. Being able to utilize the mana channels efficiently requires years of both mental and physical practice."

"flip" 2

"Because Augmenting involves extracting the user's mana core, the purest form of mana, there are no highly notable distinctions in an elemental sense. However, Augmenters are able to control their mana more freely, resulting in vastly different forms of fighting through Augmentation."

"flip"

"The phenomenon called 'Backlash' occurs in both types of practitioners. For Augmenters, it occurs from depletion of the mana core, causing extreme bodily pains depending on how strenuous the damage to the mana core is. For Conjurers, backlash occurs from overfilling of the mana core. This is caused by overuse of spells beyond the practitioner's capacity or using a spell too powerful for his or her mana core to handle."

Closing the book, I propped myself up to my butt, digesting the overload of information that I just read. 2

18

Because of the uncanny similarities between the ki center from my old world and the mana core in this world, I found it hard to believe that you needed to be a young adolescent to manipulate mana. In my old world, children started meditating and sensing their own ki scattered inside their body. Once the ki migrates into a single place, the ki center forms.

Testing my hypothesis, I began meditating, trying to sense the mana in my 7 month old body when...

"There you are! Art honey, are you having trouble taking a poop?" 4

Mother! I'm about to begin my journey to become the greatest Mage in this world! Do not make me out to be a constipated infant!

Picking me up and gently placing me in her arms, I was forcibly taken away to have my diapers changed, which, surprisingly, were full by the time I noticed

End of chapter



COMMENT

1 comment

Vote

1 left



Chapter 3: Head Start

ALICE LEYWIN'S POV:

Arthur has to be the most adorable baby, and I'm not saying this as a doting mother.

No.

Him and his scruffy little patch of glowing auburn hair and playful eyes that almost radiate a blue light, while his gaze, at times, seem almost... intelligent

No no, I told you, I'm not a doting mother. I plan to be a strict and just mother. I can't rely on my husband to teach little Art any common sense. For God's sake, I tried to teach my baby how to fight when he can now barely crawl.

I know this little rascal will turn out just like his father if I leave him be. As soon as he started crawling, I was so proud I was on the verge of shedding tears, but I didn't know how much of a handful he'd be as soon as he became mobile.

I swear, there's not a single moment where I can take my eyes off of him before he crawls into the study room. How weird. We made sure to buy him lots of stuffed animals and wooden toys to play with but he always ends up going back to the study room. THAT, at least was directly opposite of his father, seeing how Reynolds almost gravitates away from texts longer than the weekly newspaper.

Looking at how excited he gets when we go out to town, I've decided to go shopping for food once every other day instead of twice a week.

No no, I told you, I'm not a doting mother. This is for his education of the outside world and for fresh food in the house. Yeah haha...that's it.

My son seems to be interested in a lot of things. I can't get enough of his head that seems so disproportional to his little body turning left and right, trying to take in everything around him. He seems particularly intrigued by his father's practices.



required taking a test so we don't send eager but ignorant adolescents to their deaths. As for the higher ranks, I've only seen a couple of A class adventurers my years of working there and I've yet to see a S class adventurer, assuming they actually exist.

Working at the Adventurer Guild, or what we just called Guild Hall, back then Valden, I got to see too many eager teens. I swear, I was surprised they didn't fall off from their ego inflating their heads.

At least they were ambitious.

One time, I was assigned to proctor a basic practical exam where the examinees just had to demonstrate fundamental competency in their mana manipulation, but before even the test began, the kid crashed straight on his back because the sword he was carrying was too heavy for him.

Talking about airheads, Reynolds back then sure came off as one. The moment he saw me in the Guild Hall, his jaw literally dropped and he just stood there until the guy behind him in line elbowed him to hurry up. He wiped his drool and managed to mumble a "... h.. hi... can I trade in the...the stuff for the mission?" and giggled as he turned beet red from embarrassment.

He managed to gather up the courage to ask me out for dinner and we just hit it off from there. Even now, I can't help but smile when I see his droopy blue puppy eyes looking at me.

Art somehow wound up with both our redeeming traits, making him that much more adorable. You should see him when I have to change his diapers. I don't know why, but he starts turning red in his cheeks and he covers his face with tiny little fingers.

Can babies his age even get embarrassed?

The next landmark that made it to my baby journal, which is purely for educational purposes by the way and not because I am a doting mother, was when he first said mama.

HE SAID MAMA!

I told him to say "mama" again and again just to make sure I didn't hear wrong. Reynolds sulked for the day because Art said "mama" before "dada."

Haha, I won!



dinner. I'm glad Reynolds gave up being an adventurer and took a post as a guard nearby for our town. Being an adventurer may bring more money but not knowing when or rather if my husband comes home is not worth any amount of extra money. ¹

To our relief, Little Art never got sick, but oftentimes, I would find him sitting still on his butt while closing his eyes. At first, I thought he was having trouble relieving himself but after checking the first couple of times, that didn't seem to be the case.

How strange, I didn't know how to really make it out. I thought babies his age were supposed to be energetic but after his episodes of escaping to the study room, he seems spend a lot of time sitting still, almost meditating.

I was worried at first but although it happens a couple times a day, it only lasts for a couple of minutes and Art seems strangely happy afterwards. The way he holds his arms up and looks up at me makes me just want to gobble him up.

Ahem Not a doting mother. ²

ARTHUR LEYWIN'S POV:

About two years has passed since I made my difficult journey to the study room. 18

Since then, I've been constantly trying to gather the little bits of mana spread in my body and focus it to try and form a mana core. Let me tell you, it is a slow and arduous task. I would find myself having an easier time trying to learn how to walk on my hands and eat with my feet in this damnable body than trying to will my mana together.

I can see why the book says that it'll take until at least the adolescent age for a person to 'awaken.' If I let the mana particles in my body move by themselves, it would take at least a decade for them to gravitate towards each other to form anything remotely close to a mana core.

Instead... A perk in having the mental capacity of an adult means I have the cognitive ability to consciously will my mana particles together. This was something I did as a child in my past life, where they teach you from youth in schools to learn how to control ki. Essentially, it's being able to sense the ki, or mana now, in your own body and force them together near the solar plexus. If left alone, the particles will eventually slowly float towards each other anyway, but I'm just grabbing the feathers and shoving it down to the ground instead of waiting for them to float down by themselves, figuratively speaking of course.



father seemed to think that throwing a child into the air would be quite enjoy While I understand there is a kind of adrenaline effect that may excite some people, when mana is used to reinforce his arms, and I am thrown into the ai a high-speed projectile, the only feeling I get is nausea and a traumatic fear o heights.

Fortunately, my mother has a pretty firm handle on my father, but my mothe scares me as well sometimes. I oftentimes catch her staring at me, half drooli looking at me like I'm some kind of premium meat. 2

I tried to adapt myself to my body by only talking in very simple sentences. A first said "mama" to let her know I wanted more food, she almost burst into t of joy. It's been a long time since I received this sort of motherly affection. Sir then, I limited myself to just trying to talk enough to get the point across, no grammar necessary.

Besides that, the pace of my training was strenuous and slow, but I was gettir pretty big head start from everybody so I wasn't complaining.

I was in the middle of gathering the mana particles. These past two years, ha not gone to waste for I finally gathered all of my mana into my solar plexus a was in the middle of condensing it into a mana core when... BOOM!

18

End of Chapter



COMMENT

3 comment



Vote

1 left



Chapter 4: My Life Now

REYNOLDS LEYWIN'S POV:

My baby boy!



turns out to be an Augmenter like his old pops. I may know the basics of Conjuring, but I can't do anything practical with it except use it as a form of mental exercise.

Alice, on the other hand, is one of the most talented people I've ever seen. Even an Emitter, she's exceptional. Back then, after she agreed to date me, she joined my party and we went on missions together. Her restorative powers were amazing in it of itself, but what shocked me the most was when she used an area of effect spell which healed allies inside. Talk about one of a kind! And I'm her husband!

Hehe... I still don't get tired of saying that. 6

Back in the good old days before Alice wanted to settle down, we would go into Beast Glades and hunt for mana beasts. Mana beasts were various unique animals and creatures that were born with the ability to absorb mana into their body and create their own mana core, which we call beast cores.

Beast cores had an unlimited amount of uses, making them very valuable and highly sought after. Of course, the higher the classes of beast cores were, the more valuable they are. Mana beasts are classified anywhere from E class (the domesticated fanged bull used for meat and leather), to your SS class monsters. I can't tell you much about those simply because I've never seen nor heard of one, but supposedly they do exist.

18

Rule of thumb, you should assume that the mana beasts are stronger than humans of the same class. This is simply because, even if we take mana out of the picture, a beast's physical body is much stronger than the average human.

While the Beast Glades were dangerous, as long as you were cautious and don't get lost, it was pretty easy to keep yourself out of trouble. The stronger beasts tend to be further down in dungeon-like caves underground or farther away. The first few tens of kilometers of the Beast Glades are pretty well mapped and as long as you were at least a C class adventurer, you'd be fine.

Once in awhile, there are missions posted up that requires a couple parties of adventurers. Those are usually for trying to clear and map the harder dungeons that aren't fully explored. If a mana beast has the power to create its own lair and have other mana beasts serving him, then you can bet there are treasures to be gained.



when he gets older. 4

I don't know what I'll do if little Art never awakens. Oh God, it doesn't matter long it takes, as long as he can train to become any kind of mage, I'll be a pro and happy father.

It's pretty easy to tell what type of mage someone will be when they awaken because, while Augmenters, Conjurers, and deviants form a translucent barrier the mana behaves differently around them during this time.

Augmenters, when they first awaken, form a sort of pushing force around the barrier, signifying that they have dominant mana channels in their body. Conjurers, on the other hand, form a vacuum of mana around them, which means that their mana veins are much more dominant. Of course the degrees of the pushing force and vacuuming force depends on their talent in either type.

I don't mean to brag, but when I first awakened, at the early age of twelve by the way, I was sleeping and the pushing force made me float for a good couple of minutes! Enough force to lift a human body? _____

Sheesh, Alice should be grateful I stopped being an adventurer and settled down. I'm not making full use of my talent... Okay don't tell your mother this. _____

18

Anyways, as soon as he awakens, I'm going to train him. If he ends up becoming a conjurer, I think I can get him a tutor from the main town since Alice and I aren't adept enough to be teaching him... _____

...Is what I said but...

BOOM!

Currently, 3/4th of the house is gone... 3

What happened?

Luckily I was with Alice in the front yard for a bit after dinner but... Art....Little Art is still in the house...

"ARTHUR!!"

Alice's face drains of all blood as I see her go pale, eyes wide in disbelief and worry. I nudge my wife down while covering her with a temporary shield that lasts for a couple minutes.



towards me as I reach deeper into the source of the explosion. After fighting myself through the scraps of what is left of my house and several pieces of rock, I finally see it.

My son had the all but noticeable translucent barrier around him. Better yet, the pushing force of his awakened powers is what caused this explosion. He was floating in the center of a crater that cleared 3/4th of our house as well as our entire backyard.

Haha...

My legs gave out and I just landed on my knees while I continued to gape at the sight. My son is almost 3 years old and he awakened. Only 3...

"I didn't know whether to laugh or cry"

"Reynolds! Honey!"

I glanced back at my wife with my mouth still hanging from shock. She managed to slowly make her way towards me, after there was no more debris to be thrown out.

She was making half-steps towards me, covering her face with her arms to shield what she could from the strong pushing force still emanating out of Art.

18

"Reynolds! What happened? What's going on? Where's Art?"

I still couldn't find my voice so I just pointed my finger towards the direction of our son.

While confused, she looked at the direction I was pointing at and all she could manage to whisper was, "Oh my..."

ARTHUR LEYWIN'S POV:

Wow I feel great!

Feeling refreshed at my breakthrough, I closed my eyes to sense my newly formed mana core. My sweet little mana core!

"ART! OH MY BABY! Are you okay?"

I see my mother rushing towards me while my father is on the ground kneeling.

What did he do this time that caused him to get punished by mother?

My mother lifts me up and hugs me, almost to the point where my underdeveloped ribs give out.



She didn't answer me and continued sobbing while cradling me. My father arrived next to her, patting her back and patting my head as well, giving me a weak smile.

After a brief moment of confusion, I peeled my head away from my mother's bosom and I looked around to see that we're standing in the center of a giant crater, with most of our house gone.

...What the fuck?

Who caused this? Who dares have the audacity to destroy the home of a King? The perpetrators will rue this day! I will hunt them down day and night and I rest until... 1

"Congrats Art honey. You awakened Champ."

I did this?

In my old world on Earth, a similar phenomenon happens when a youth awakens. A clear barrier appears around the awakened and a small pushing force surrounds the barrier. I'm guessing, though, that the pushing force in this world is a lot stronger because of the mana in the atmosphere, something that wasn't there back on Earth.

As once a King of integrity, I decided on apologizing for this... er.. situation.

18

"I'm sorry Mom, Dad. Am I in trouble?"

"Haha... No Art honey, you're not in trouble. We were just worried about you. I'm glad you're alright." My mother managed to chuckle through half-teared eyes.

My idiot father, on the other hand, was a lot more excited.

"My boy is a genius! Awakened at the age of less than three! This is unprecedented! I thought I was fast but jeez!"

So a couple of moments of a picture-perfect atmosphere was broken when a neighbor passing by screamed, "What in the world?!"

"Haha, we better clean this mess up" my father grins while rubbing the back of his head.



Adventurer party members to help rebuild the lost part of our house while we stayed in the nearby inn. With conjurers raising the ground for the foundation of the house and augmenters doing the grunt work, the house didn't take too long to finish. The beauty of magic! Surprisingly, none of my father's ex party members seemed to question why our house blew up.

That seems to say a lot about my idiot father. 2

During the middle of reconstructing our house, my birthday came around (May 29). My parents woke me up that morning with a present and what seemed to be a loaf of....bread? in their hands.

Ahh! It was a cake!... would've been easier to tell if it wasn't black.

Opening the present box to find a carefully carved, wooden sword, I hugged both my parents, thanking them for the present and cake.

This surprised me because my parents didn't bother to celebrate my past two birthdays so I assumed this world didn't really celebrate it. I later found out that birthdays are celebrated starting at the age of 3 because of a tradition from a long time ago when babies were more susceptible to death before the age of three.

How medieval.

18

Another thing I took an interest in noticing.

Seeing children as well as teens working in farms with their family and forge apprentices made me realize there was no mandatory form of a structured education system.

Any sort of rudimentary education was provided by their families (just basics of reading and writing).

As soon as I turned three, my mother began giving me lessons for a set time, teaching me how to read and write. Playing the role of a genius son, I pretended to learn quickly, to her delight, so I can read harder books in the library without drawing suspicion.

These last couple of weeks passed by in a blast. After awakening, my father taught me the basics of mana and how to start training in it as best as he could. He tried to simplify as much as possible so that a toddler can understand I guess but if it wasn't for my adult comprehensive abilities, I don't think I would've retained much.



An easy way to know where you stand in strength lies in the color of your mana core. When you start off, the mana core is black, due to the body's blood and impurities mixing with the mana particles as they formed together to be a mana core. As the mana inside the person's body becomes more pure and the impurities are filtered out, it'll turn to a dark red color. From there, the lighter the mana core's color will become; from dark red, to a red, and then to a lighter red.

The order goes as follows: black, red, orange, yellow, silver, and then white.

From the red mana core 'til the yellow mana core, the colors split into three shades of that said color (Dark Orange, Orange, Light Orange). Rule of thumb: the lighter the mana core color, the more pure one's mana core is and the more power they have access to.

While the lessons with my father proved useful, I was getting impatient at the pace. I asked mother a couple days later, "Mom, can I get books on magic?"

Since my mother still had connections in the Guild Hall (Adventurer Guild), she managed to acquire a pretty good collection of books on basic mana manipulation as well as fighting with different weapons. Some of them were picture books with only simple words and mostly pictures of basics on how to use magic, but I ignored those. My mother gave me a strange look because the books that I've been looking at were on a higher level. She assumed I would even be able to understand most of the words in there and tried to cajole me into some of the simpler books, saying that it'll be easier to understand, but eventually she relented.

A typical day would involve taking reading and writing lessons from mother and augmenting training with my father. After he covered the basic theory and application of Augmenting, we started physical training. Seeing how my body was too small to start sparring, we opted to running, and body workouts. I think seeing my three-year-old body trying to do a pushup would be the funniest thing, but my father did a good job holding in his laughter.

When I'm not taking either lessons, I usually stay cooped up in the newly improved library, reading and meditating to further condense my mana core.

As the year passed and not much was happening outside of my typical day, my father spoke up while we were having dinner one night.

"Honey, I think it's time we get Art a proper mentor." 1

End of Chapter